

Jamie Cheng

An Educational Program Manager and Organizational Development Professional
Dedicated to Improving Student Experience and Program Quality

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Dear Hiring Committee,

When I came across the Undergraduate Program Manager role in Columbia's Department of Economics, it felt like the kind of position I've been quietly building toward. The work blends **educational program operations**, **student-facing coordination**, and using program data to drive improvement—three areas that have shaped most of my last few years.

I'm Jamie Cheng, an **Organizational Development and Program Management professional** with an MS in Applied Organizational Psychology from USC (3.95 GPA) and a BA in Psychology and Education Studies from Wesleyan University (4.00 GPA). My undergraduate years at Wesleyan included serving as a Student Engagement Ambassador at the Fries Center for Global Studies, where I planned International Education Week with university offices and student organizations, organized intercultural events, and conducted **MaxQda focus-group analysis** to surface barriers in study abroad participation. That experience gave me direct insight into how an undergraduate program office actually runs.

Three areas where I think I'd contribute right away:

Educational program operations. At InGenius Prep, my day-to-day is essentially what this role describes—overseeing a portfolio of educational programs, coordinating with vendors and internal teams, monitoring program budgets, and managing the communications cycle that keeps students, parents, and staff aligned. I've come to find real satisfaction in the rhythm of this work: program logistics, stakeholder partnership, and the small process improvements that compound over time.

Student engagement, communications, and events. Outside InGenius, I've also worked one-on-one with four high school students over two years as a part-time admissions counselor, walking them through career exploration, college list development, and essay writing—all four landed at reach or top-choice schools. I'm at my best when helping students navigate big educational decisions, and when the work involves the kind of community-building this role calls for.

Program assessment and data-informed improvement. Some of my most rewarding work has been turning student and stakeholder voice into something a department can actually act on—whether through survey analysis at NextGen Healthcare or focus-group research at the Fries Center that informed Study Abroad Office outreach. I find this kind of work genuinely energizing, and I'm comfortable on both the qualitative and quantitative sides of it.

I'd love the chance to contribute to the Department of Economics and to support the students and faculty who make the program what it is. Thank you for considering my application—I'd welcome a conversation.

Sincerely,

Jamie Cheng